THE SALES STRUCTURING MANUAL

From guesswork **to predictable**

The step-by-step to build a sales operation from scratch, with method, team and CRM.

Stop depending on referrals, on luck and on yourself. This guide shows you, step by step, how to build a sales engine that closes every month, with the right people and a real process.

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Sales structuring specialists

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OPENING

Selling can't be a matter of luck.

Every company that grew fast lived the same scene. Revenue rises one month and drops the next. A customer closes through a referral, and nobody can explain where it came from. The owner is, at the same time, the best (and sometimes the only) salesperson in the house.

That works up to a point. Then it becomes a ceiling. The company doesn't grow because sales don't scale, and sales don't scale because there's no system behind them, only effort, individual talent and improvisation.

The good news is that sales aren't a gift. They're a **system**. There's a sales-structuring model used by the biggest companies in the world that turns selling into a process: predictable, measurable and replicable. It's not magic, it's engineering. And that's exactly what you'll learn to build here.

THE PREMISE OF THIS MANUAL

You don't need one more good salesperson. You need an operation. When the operation exists, the right salesperson comes in and performs. Without it, even the best salesperson sinks.

In the pages ahead, no loose theory. It's a step-by-step from guesswork to predictable: how to design the offer, attract the right customer, separate pre-sales from sales, hire and train the team, build the CRM and manage by metrics. Everything a real sales operation needs to run, even when you're not standing in front of it.

Welcome. Let's build your sales machine.

By Gabriel Isidoro and Renan Paiva · Sales structuring specialists

WHY NOW

The sales game changed. Those who didn't structure fell behind.

A few years ago, a structured sales operation was a luxury for big companies. Today it's a matter of survival. Whoever keeps selling the way they sold five years ago is already losing ground, even without noticing.

The customer changed

More informed and more demanding. They decide based on trust built across several steps, not a single contact.

The competition changed

Your direct competitor may already have an SDR, a CRM and a cadence. You compete against process, not just price.

The tools changed

CRM, automation and AI made the game accessible. Structuring got cheaper than staying on guesswork.

What structure (really) means

A sales process is a set of steps designed to lead your ideal customer to trust your brand and move forward, step after step, all the way to the purchase. At each step, credibility grows and the odds of closing rise. Structuring sales is designing and optimizing each of those steps, from the first ad to the post-sale.

IT WORKS FOR ALMOST ANY BUSINESS

The model works in both B2B (agencies, SaaS, services, industry, energy, construction) and high-ticket B2C (real estate, financing, investments, health, education). The only real exception is selling to government (B2G), which follows a different logic.

BEFORE YOU START

Who this manual is for and what you'll build.

This guide is for you if you...

Own the business and still sell

Sales stall the moment you step away. Your calendar became hostage to follow-up and "I'll get back to you later."

Already tried hiring a rep

You hired, waited three months, it never ramped, you swapped, and you still have zero predictability.

Are tired of the rollercoaster

One month explodes, the next dries up. You want revenue that rises with method, not with luck.

Want a system, not heroes

You want an operation that runs on process and data, and doesn't depend on any single person.

What you'll know how to do by the end

- Define your ideal customer (ICP) and design a product ladder and offers that sell.
- Build acquisition funnels that fill the team's calendar predictably.
- Separate pre-sales from sales, with a cadence, scripts and a closing protocol.
- Size, hire, train and compensate the right sales team.
- Build the CRM, automations and management by metrics, from MVP to scale.

Read with a pen in hand. Every chapter ends with a practical action. If you apply it as you read, by the time you finish you'll already have half of your operation on paper.

CONTENTS

The path of this manual

> **A salesperson doesn't build an operation. A salesperson works inside an operation that already exists.**
>
> That operation is what you'll build, chapter by chapter.

PART ONE

01

The turning point

Before building anything, you have to see the difference between fighting fires and running a system. This part shows what changes when sales stops being guesswork.

The guesswork loop | The 5 pillars | The sales MVP

01 CHAPTER ONE

Guesswork vs system

The difference between companies that scale sales and those that live on the up-and-down isn't the salesperson's talent. It's whether or not there's an operation behind them.

Sales on guesswork vs a structured operation

On guesswork

- Leads come in with no response cadence
- One person does everything and closes nothing well
- Disorganized CRM, invisible funnel
- Owner stuck in day-to-day operations
- Growth by referral and luck

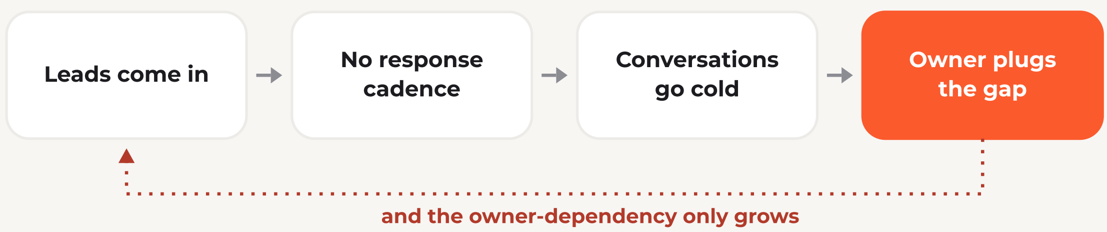
Structured

- Right customer (ICP) and a targeted approach
- Each role in place: prospecting and closing
- CRM with stages, cadence and indicators
- Owner on strategy, not operations
- Growth with method and predictability

The guesswork loop (and why it doesn't break on its own)

Without structure, the company enters a loop that feeds itself. The more the owner plugs the gap by hand, the more the operation depends on them. And the more dependent it is, the harder it is to get out.

THE GUESSWORK LOOP

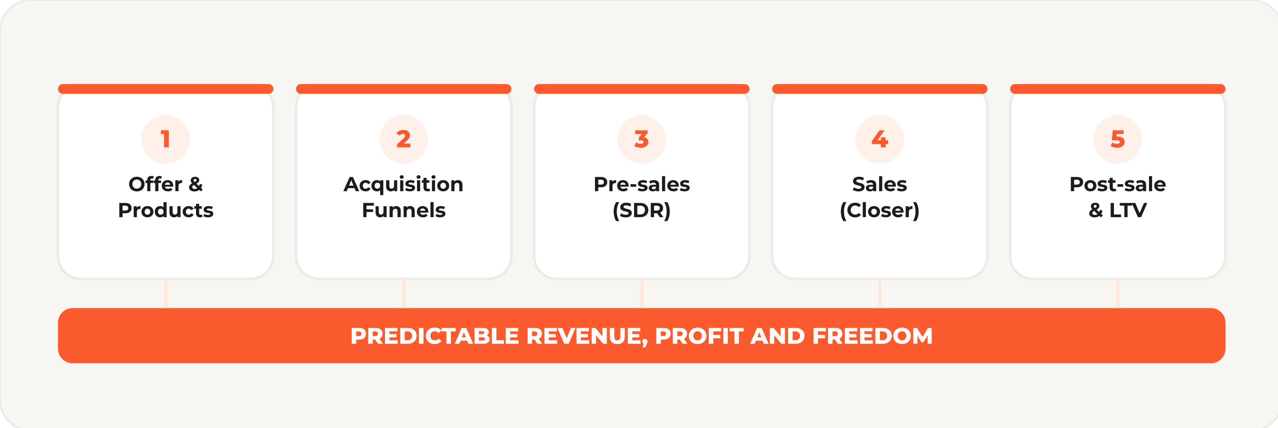


THE HONEST TEST

If you step away for 30 days, what happens to your sales? The answer says everything about the stage of your operation. An operation that depends on one person isn't an operation, it's a bottleneck.

The 5 pillars of a sales operation

Every high-performance sales operation rests on five gears. They work in sequence and feed each other: each one improves the result of the next.



1 • Offer & Products

The product architecture and offer engineering. It defines cash, margin and what the team sells.

2 • Acquisition funnels

The lead intake doors. Marketing (with traffic) and sales (without traffic).

3 • Pre-sales (SDR)

First contact, qualification and booking. Protects the closer's calendar.

4 • Sales (Closer)

The closing meeting, with a protocol, active listening and technique.

5 • Post-sale & LTV

The first sale is just the start. Delivery, repeat, upgrade and referral are where the long-term profit lives.

START WITH THE MVP

You don't build all five pillars complete at once. You start with a minimum viable structure and keep adding channels, people and processes as the operation grows. Knowing *what* to do matters as much as knowing **when** to do it.

What works and what doesn't

Before moving on, get the right beliefs about building a sales operation straight. This is the difference between building an asset and burning money.

Works

- Hand the manager a ready base of processes and track the execution
- An in-house team that knows your product and your customer
- Treating sales as the heart of the company, an asset that takes work upfront and returns later
- Owning it to the company to train, guide and equip the team

Doesn't work

- Paying a manager a fortune expecting them to build everything alone
- Thinking the rep "gets paid to sell" and the rest is their problem
- Kicking the can down the road and living with owner-dependency
- Expecting someone from outside to care about your business more than you

3x
more expensive to fix a broken sales operation than to build it right from the start

+50%
of leads never get a second contact in operations run on guesswork

1
irreplaceable person holding it all together: usually, you

The central decision of this manual: build your sales operation as an asset of your company, in-house, documented and yours. It's more work at the start, and it's the only path that creates real independence.

PART TWO

02

The foundation: offer & products

No funnel saves a weak offer. It all starts with knowing who you sell to and what you sell. This is the base the whole machine rests on.

ICP | Product ladder | Offer engineering

02 CHAPTER TWO

Ideal customer (ICP)

ICP (Ideal Customer Profile) is the ideal customer for your company. Defining it well is the cheapest and most profitable decision you make in sales, because it steers your marketing, your qualification and the very expensive time of your closing team.

The 3 criteria of an ideal customer

Aware of the problem

They already know they have the problem and, ideally, have started looking for a solution.

High transformation potential

Your solution has a strong power to transform their reality. It feels tailor-made.

Financial capacity

They can pay for the solution without it becoming a financial problem.

ICP IS NOT A CAGE

Defining your ICP doesn't stop you from serving someone outside the profile who still gets results. It's a north star for product, offer and prospecting, not a growth limiter. So also define a **minimum ideal customer**: the minimum that must be true for you to be able to deliver results.

ICP clarity is what lets your pre-sales team decide, with criteria, who deserves to move to a meeting. Without it, the closer wastes valuable hours on leads that were never going to close.

Minimum ideal customer vs ideal customer

See how to tell the floor (who you can already serve well) from the target (who you want to attract more and more). The examples below illustrate the reasoning, adapt them to your market.

Profile	Minimum ideal customer	Ideal customer (target)
Clinic / healthcare	Established clinic doing over $15K/month	Clinic doing $80K to $300K/month
Digital / coaching	Info product or coaching from $10K/month	Digital operation of $30K to $300K/month
High-ticket services	High-ticket service doing $12K to $15K/month	$60K to $300K/month ($600K+/year)

How to define yours, in practice

1. List your 10 best customers (the most profitable, least demanding, most referring).
2. Find the pattern: segment, revenue, stage, main pain, buying trigger.
3. Write your ICP in one sentence. E.g.: "owner of [segment] doing [range] who struggles with [pain]".
4. Define the minimum ideal customer: the acceptable floor for the team to book with confidence.
5. Turn that into objective qualification criteria for pre-sales to use.

CHAPTER ACTION

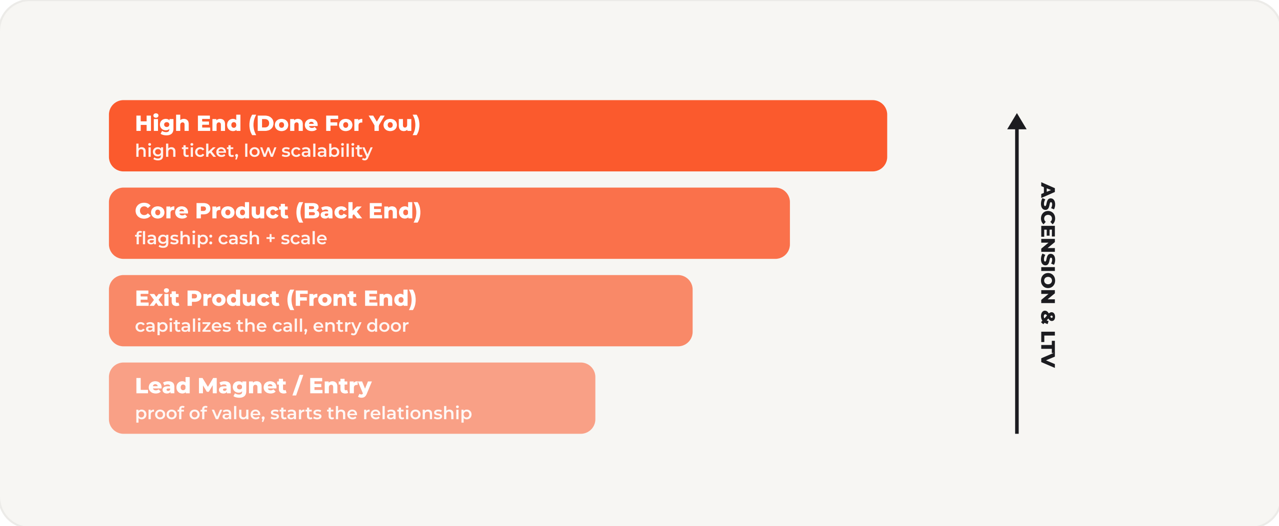
Write, right now, in one sentence, your ICP and your minimum ideal customer. They'll be the ruler for every decision ahead.

03

CHAPTER THREE

Product ladder and value ladder

The job of the product ladder is to give your business different price points, a value ladder, so you earn more (by delivering more value) per lead and per customer over time.



The customer can enter at any rung, from the top (high ticket) or the bottom (entry ticket), but the ascension path has to be clear. Like Apple: someone can start with a cheap accessory and reach a laptop, or walk in buying the top product. What matters is that **the next step always makes sense** in the customer's experience.

WHY THIS MATTERS

A well-designed value ladder guarantees two things: predictability of new sales and LTV generation (the customer stays and buys more over time). It's the difference between selling once and building a base.

The product types on the ladder

Back End: the flagship

Your main offer: a mix of scalable and profitable. It serves your ideal customer directly. It's where you invest the most marketing, sales and delivery time. It's the product the team pushes most.

High End: high ticket

Brings even more cash per sale, but scales poorly (usually "done for you", delivered by your company). You charge more for the effort. Great early on to reinvest in building the other products.

Front End: exit product

Creates an ascension door to the Back End and capitalizes every call. It lets the closer not walk away "empty-handed" when the customer doesn't close the main offer right away.

Lead magnet / entry

Acquires the customer with a low-barrier entry product (a "proof of value") that later ascends to the main offers. It's not always about profit: it's about starting the relationship.

Complementary products

Items that raise the ticket and the satisfaction: add-ons, extended warranties, extra services. They lift the average sale value without requiring a new acquisition process.

CAREFUL

A great product isn't enough. If the offer is weak, the closer undersells it, closes on the worst terms and doesn't create the needed value. That's why the next chapter is on offer engineering.

04 CHAPTER FOUR

Offer engineering

A good offer isn't just price. It's a layered construction that raises perceived value and shortens the sales cycle. Here's the structure your closer will use inside the meeting.

List price anchoring base, shown first	$X
Promo condition valid on the call only, with 1-2 bonuses	-20%
Immediate-decision bonus breaks objections, speeds the yes	+ value
Last condition final play to close on the call	-5 to 7%
Closing levers concessions saved for the impasse	reserve

Anchoring

An honest comparison that shows the solution is worth more than it costs. Avoid absurd anchors: exaggeration breeds distrust, not desire.

List price

The "full" condition. It's not where you want to close, it's the base the customer anchors the value on before the promo condition.

Promo condition

Usually ~20% off the list, valid on the call only, with 1 to 2 bonuses for deciding. It has a short, real deadline.

Immediate-decision bonus

Extra deliverables unlocked only with the promo condition. They break objections and discourage procrastination.

THE GOLDEN RULE

Keep your word. If the customer doesn't close within the agreed deadline, the promo condition and the bonuses don't come back. It's fair to those who decided and protects the value of your offer long-term.

The product board

Organize everything in one place: product, list price, promo condition, last condition, bonuses and closing levers. This board is what the closer studies and uses in the meeting, and what the SDR references during qualification.

Product	List price	Promo	Last condition	Ace up the sleeve
Example: Core Program	$12,000 upfront	$9,600 or 12x $880 + bonuses A and B	$9,100 or 12x $830 + bonus C	30-day access + implementation session
Exit product (Front End)	$2,500	$1,990	$1,800	Value credited toward the main purchase

Illustrative values. The board's goal is to standardize the negotiation and take improvisation out of the sales meeting.

Closing levers

These are concessions not yet presented, saved for the final impasse: waiving a fee, an easy-to-provide bonus, or an extra deadline. Use one at a time, and only when needed.

CHAPTER ACTION

Build your company's product board with all the offer layers. Without it, every rep negotiates their own way.

PART THREE

03

The machine: acquisition, pre-sales and sales

With the foundation ready, it's time to get the operation running: attract leads, qualify with a cadence and close with method. And then, turn a customer into repeat business.

Funnels | Pre-sales | Sales | Post-sale

05

CHAPTER FIVE

Acquisition funnels

Funnels are the lead intake doors. There are two types, and the ideal is to start with one of each: together, they already guarantee a jump in revenue without much operational effort.

Marketing funnel

Depends on ads and paid traffic. Attracts leads at scale who go to pre-sales. E.g.: Diagnostic Funnel with VSL.

Sales funnel

Doesn't depend on traffic: it runs on the team's effort. E.g.: Social Selling, active prospecting and relationship-building on social.

PRINCIPLE

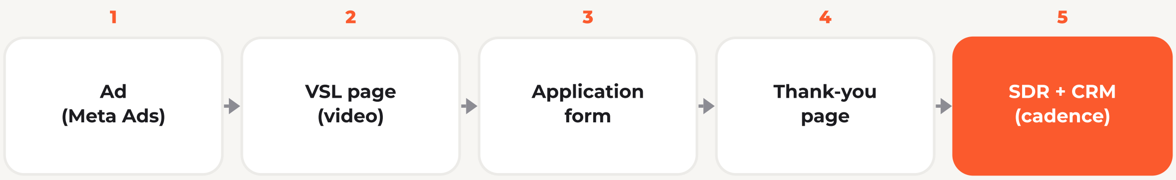
Don't depend on a single way to attract customers. One source creates a growth bottleneck and leaves you hostage to a channel. Compose funnels that attract your ideal customer through different paths.

The two funnels to start with

- **Diagnostic Funnel with VSL** (marketing): a sales video that raises awareness and leads to an application.
- **Social Selling Funnel** (sales): relationship and prospecting via Instagram, LinkedIn and DMs.
- **Bonus · Paid lead magnet:** more work, so it's the third priority, after the first two are running.

Diagnostic Funnel with VSL

The VSL (Video Sales Letter) delivers your message more clearly and persuasively than text or images. It's a video that raises the lead's awareness and a CTA that leads to an application. Start with the short version (5 minutes): more direct, less work and faster to results.



MARKETING funnel: depends on paid traffic to generate leads

Step-by-step to build it

1. Build the funnel page and host it (on a page builder or similar).
2. Write the script, record and edit the sales video.
3. Create the application form and the thank-you page.
4. Connect all the pieces to your CRM and set up emails and messaging.
5. Produce 5 static ads and 5 video ads, define the audience in Meta Ads and organize it all in a spreadsheet.

DONE

With that, your marketing funnel is live. From here, the game is optimizing creatives, page and qualification.

Social Selling Funnel

Social Selling is building relationship as part of the sale, usually via Instagram and LinkedIn. It's fast, predictable and controllable, ideal for getting your funnels off the ground. It works in two flows:

PROACTIVE · you go to the lead

New follower → Outreach in DMs → Conversation & relationship → Booking with Closer

PROMPTED · the lead comes to you

Strategic post → Lead's comment → DM automation → Booking with Closer

How to get the funnel ready

1. Publish prompting Social Selling posts 1 to 3 times a week, depending on your audience size.
2. Connect the posts to DM automations (e.g., ManyChat), with an activation keyword in the caption.
3. Structure the start of the conversation to build relationship and lead to a booking.
4. Test the automation end to end before scaling.

BONUS · PAID LEAD MAGNET

It's a more complex, more work-intensive marketing funnel. Don't put it in the first month: leave it as the next priority once VSL and Social Selling are running.

06 CHAPTER SIX
Pre-sales (SDR)

Pre-sales is the sub-area responsible for protecting the closer's time. It makes the first contact, qualifies, books qualified meetings, reschedules and keeps the follow-up alive.

The 4 types of SDR

SDR 1: Funnels

Handles the leads who signed up through funnels and are within the cadence period (about 1 month).

SDR 2: Social Seller

Works inbound and outbound Social Selling, building relationship, conversations and bookings.

SDR 3: Hunter

Actively prospects people and businesses within the ICP who have no contact with the company yet.

SDR 4: Sales Farmer

Runs the coordinated, periodic re-engagement of old contact lists and stalled leads.

COMBINE ROLES EARLY

Start with one person (or two, depending on volume) covering SDR 1 and SDR 2. The other roles come in as the operation grows.

Each SDR needs a **pre-sales playbook**: an outreach process, a call script, a messaging script, automated follow-ups, fair lead distribution in the CRM and an objection-handling sheet.

Cadence: where sales actually happen

The costliest mistake in pre-sales is giving up early. Most stop at the third contact, right before the window where the majority of sales happen.

A multichannel cadence (message, call, email, voice note) keeps the lead warm without being intrusive. The end of the cadence, the "break-up", is often the contact that converts most: it's the last call that prompts a reply.

Objection handling

An objection isn't a "no", it's a lack of information or perceived value. Have ready answers for the 5 or 6 most common objections in your market (price, timing, trust, priority, decision-maker). Document, train and update.

CHAPTER ACTION

Define your cadence of at least 8 to 12 touches, with channels and days. Automate the follow-ups in the CRM and never let a lead die at the first silence.

07 CHAPTER SEVEN
Sales (Closer)

Selling at high performance is creating an atmosphere in which the customer makes a decision, on the call, where you have the most control. It's a sale built on lots of active listening, lots of prep and technique.

1. Intro & rapport
2. Discovery (SPIN)
3. Present the solution
4. Anchoring & offer
5. Closing & objections

1 • Intro & rapport

Ice-breaker, context and a clear agenda for the call. The closer is the one who runs the meeting.

2 • Discovery (SPIN)

Questions that reveal situation, problem, implication and need. This is where the sale is built.

3 • Presentation

Connects the solution exactly to the pains raised. You present what matters, not everything that exists.

4 • Anchoring & offer

List price, promo condition and bonus, in the right order, creating a value contrast.

5 • Closing & objections

Lead to the decision, handle objections naturally and use the closing levers when needed. This can take 20 minutes to 2 hours, in one or two calls, depending on the ticket.

SPIN Selling: the heart of discovery

The secret to a high-value sale isn't in the presentation, it's in the questions. The SPIN method organizes the investigation into four types of question, which lead the customer to see the value of the solution on their own.

S	P	I	N
Situation	**Problem**	**Implication**	**Need**
Understand the customer's context and current state	Surface the real pains and difficulties	Amplify the cost of not solving the problem	Get the customer to verbalize the solution's value

Approaches built on active listening and discovery, instead of "pushing" the product, tend to strongly raise conversion and shorten the sales cycle, two decisive factors for scaling sustainably.

> **PRACTICAL RULE**
>
> The customer should talk more than the salesperson during discovery. If your closer is talking 80% of the time, they're presenting too early, and selling less.

The 3 indicators every closer tracks

Close rate
how many meetings become a sale

Sales cycle
how long from meeting to close

Average deal size
whether the team sells the higher-value products

To structure the sales function

1. Create a sales playbook with all the guidelines for the closer team.
2. Document the closer's process: intro, SPIN, presentation, anchoring and closing.
3. Build professional sales presentation slides for the high ticket.
4. Record the closing meetings to train the team with real cases.

CHAPTER ACTION

Record your next 5 sales meetings. They become, at the same time, training material and the documented standard your team will replicate.

08 CHAPTER EIGHT

Post-sale & LTV

The first sale is just the start of a relationship. The post-sale, which includes delivery and operation, is today one of the most profitable areas of a mature sales operation, and the most neglected by immature ones.

Delivery that delights

Think Apple, Amazon, BMW: the expected delivery level is high. A well-delivered product becomes the company's biggest sales channel.

Repeat and upgrade

A satisfied customer ascends the value ladder. Selling again to someone who already trusts you is far cheaper than acquiring.

Referral

A strong post-sale turns customers into a recurring source of new qualified leads, for free.

Ambassadors

Your best customers become social proof and open doors to new contracts. It's marketing you don't pay for.

THE PROFIT LIVES HERE

Acquiring a customer is expensive. The real margin of a mature business comes from repeat, upgrade and referral. Structuring the post-sale is structuring profit, not just satisfaction.

Build a Customer Success pipeline with clear stages: onboarding, follow-up, renewal and loyalty. The post-sale needs a process too, not just goodwill.

PART FOUR

04

The people & the system

Process without the right people doesn't move; the right people without tools get lost. This part is about sizing, hiring, training and giving the team the CRM that holds it all together.

Capacity planning | Sales hiring | CRM & technology

09 CHAPTER NINE

Sales capacity planning

How many people do you need? Sizing it right is balancing profit and sustainability, without overloading the team or inflating payroll too early.

15 to 25	15-25%	3 to 4	20-30%+
new leads / day	booking rate	calls / day per Closer	close rate
≈ 1 SDR	pre-sales targets	1 SDR ≈ 1 Closer	sales targets

Pre-sales (SDR)

1 SDR handles ~15 to 25 new leads per day (450 to 750/month). Booking targets: 10% (minimum), 15% (base), 20% (intermediate), 25% (target). With AI support, an SDR processes far more leads.

Sales (Closer)

1 closer handles 3 to 4 calls per day (below 2 is idle, above 5 performance drops). Close-rate targets: 15% (minimum), 20% (base), 25% (intermediate), 30%+ (target). Rule of thumb: 1 closer ≈ 1 SDR.

Starting scenarios

Option	Composition	When to use
Option 1 safest	1 SDR/Social Seller + partner/founder as closer	The start. You take the closing seat to calibrate the offer and record example calls.
Option 2	1 SDR + 1 closer + partner as manager	When Option 1 isn't possible and you can already delegate the closing.
Option 3 riskiest	2 SDRs + 2 closers + manager	An already-structured company that wants to accelerate. Requires maturity so it doesn't become cost without return.

These are starting sizes. With traction and safety, the team grows as demand does.

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CHAPTER TEN

Sales hiring: recruit and train

Hiring wrong is the costliest mistake in sales. The solution isn't to "find a good salesperson", it's to have a recruiting funnel that filters before you hire.

1. **Define each role's profile**
2. **Job post + job VSL**
3. **Pre-training that filters**
4. **Interview + role play**
5. **Onboarding & ongoing training**

The profile of each role

SDR

Command of prospecting and follow-up. Soft skills: assertive communication, resilience, discipline and emotional control under quota.

Closer

Strong closing and negotiation skills. Emotional control under pressure and the ability to adapt in real time.

EMPLOYER BRAND

Good people choose where to work. Have a careers page with culture and testimonials, and post the job with a job VSL, explaining the role, the targets and the company's vision. A well-sold job attracts a better candidate.

A pre-training that filters and a structured interview

Before hiring, put the candidate through a short pre-training (24 to 72h) with online content about the sales process, funnel stages and CRM, ending with a questionnaire. This teaches *and* filters: it reveals commitment and learning ability before you spend a salary.

- **SDR interview:** focus on persuasion technique, discipline, resilience and emotional control.
- **Closer interview:** closing technique and a role play simulating objections and final negotiation.

Compensation structure (reference)

Role	Base	Variable	Benefits
SDR	~$2,200	$12 to $15 per booking + target bonuses	Performance incentives
Closer	~$3,000	3 to 5% commission	Conversion incentive
Manager	~$5,000 to $6,500	0.5 to 0.7% + target bonuses	Housing stipend, annual profit-share

Reference market values; adjust to your reality. The principle: tie a good share of pay to results, keeping a base that provides security.

RETENTION

A clear career path, weekly recognition (leaderboards), biweekly targets, ongoing training and wellness benefits. Keeping a good rep is cheaper than rehiring.

11 CHAPTER ELEVEN

CRM & technology

The CRM is the core of the operation: it centralizes contacts, automations, communication channels, tasks and reports. It's what turns knowledge stuck in people's heads into an asset of the company.

BEFORE

Operating in the dark

- Sales in the owner's head
- Lead lost in the inbox
- A sheet nobody updates
- Forgotten follow-up
- Rep leaves and takes the client

AFTER

Operating with a CRM

- Funnel visible by stage
- Automatic cadence and follow-up
- Everything logged
- Real-time dashboard
- Team changes, the operation stays

The essential modules

Contact management

Centralizes all lead and customer information in one place.

Automation

Emails, reminders, notifications and automatic lead follow-up.

Reports

Sales, conversion and engagement metrics to decide with data.

The sales pipelines

Each function has its own pipeline (Kanban), with the stages and actions specific to that phase. Structuring the pipelines is what makes the funnel visible and manageable.

PRE-SALES	SALES	CUSTOMER SUCCESS
Lead intake	Booked	Onboarding
First interaction	No-show	Follow-up
Follow up 1-3	Sale with deposit	Renewal
Booking	Sale closed	Loyalty
Reschedule	Farming	
Sales farming		

Essential automations

- Automatic reminders for follow-ups, meetings and tasks, so no opportunity slips.
- Nurture flows and lead scoring to prioritize who's ready for outreach.
- Automatic movement of the lead between stages as they respond and act.
- Email, phone and messaging integration to centralize all communication in the CRM.
- Integrated booking, with reminders that reduce no-shows.

CRM routine and adoption

A CRM only works if the team uses it. And the team uses it when the routine is clear and logging is incentivized, not optional.

Daily routine

SDRs check new leads, update statuses and do follow-ups. Heads review the CRM daily to catch delays and gaps.

Weekly routine

Pipeline review and an alignment meeting to discuss blockers and adjustments. Weekly and monthly KPI monitoring.

ADOPTION IS MANAGEMENT

Automate what benefits the team (so they want to use it) and have consequences for not logging: fewer leads for SDRs, or a blocked calendar for closers who don't follow the process. What's not in the CRM didn't happen.

Connect the CRM to dashboards and BI tools to track conversion, sales cycle and other KPIs in real time. That's what sets the stage for the next part: managing by metrics.

CHAPTER ACTION

Design your 3 pipelines (pre-sales, sales, customer success) with the stages in this chapter and set up the 5 essential automations.

PART FIVE

05

Management & scale

What you don't measure, you can't manage. Here you learn to read the right numbers, find the bottleneck, use AI to your advantage and build the plan to go from guesswork to predictable.

Metrics & KPIs | Bottlenecks | AI | Plan

12 CHAPTER TWELVE

Management by metrics

Managing sales is managing numbers. Track primary metrics (which measure the result) and secondary ones (which explain the result). Together, they show exactly where to act.

Primary metrics

- CAC: customer acquisition cost
- Cost per show
- Revenue per call held
- ROAS: return on ad spend

Secondary metrics

- Cost per lead
- Booking rate and show-up rate
- Close rate
- Average deal size and revenue by source

Ideal reference KPIs

Indicator	Ideal KPI
Time to contact after a lead	< 5 minutes (1 hour max)
Booking rate	above 20% (minimum 12%)
Show-up rate	> 65% (B2C) · > 70% (B2B)
Close rate	between 20% and 35%
ROAS	above 7; ideally > 10 to scale

The management routine

Sales manager

Monitors targets daily, trains the closers (simulations and call reviews), aligns weekly with marketing and pre-sales and gives individual feedback.

Pre-sales manager

Daily role play with SDRs, review of cadences and follow-ups, daily analysis of contact attempts and biweekly results meetings.

Bottleneck diagnosis

When results drop, the problem is in a specific stage. Use this table to go straight to the cause:

Symptom	Where to act
High cost per lead	Adjust creatives and audiences, optimize funnel and entry offer
Low lead volume	Increase budget, revise ads, reinforce active prospecting
Low booking rate	Train SDRs and improve the leads' entry content
Low show-up rate	Triple reinforcement of reminders and booking confirmation
Low close rate	Intensive closer training, adjust presentation and offer
Low average deal size	Create higher-value offers and train anchoring

13 CHAPTER THIRTEEN

AI in sales

AI doesn't replace the team, it multiplies its capacity. Applied well, it automates the grunt work of qualification and booking and frees the humans for what matters: relationship and closing.

Automatic qualification

AI starts and runs conversations, qualifies leads by predefined criteria and answers frequent questions 24/7.

Booking and follow-up

Offers time slots, confirms meetings and sends reminders, reducing no-shows and the time the team spends.

Multichannel

Operates on Instagram, Facebook, messaging and chat at once, creating an omnichannel experience.

Real-time data

Monitors response rate and initial conversion, helping you adjust intake and qualification on the fly.

The 3 bot modes

1. **Suggestive:** the AI suggests answers to the SDR, who keeps control of the conversation.
2. **Automatic:** the AI runs it from start to finish and hands off to a human on complex cases.
3. **Off:** no automation, when full personalization is required.

START SIMPLE

Roll out AI in suggestive mode first, train it with your tone of voice and your qualification criteria, and only then move to automatic. Always with a human supervising and adjusting.

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CHAPTER FOURTEEN

Revenue without spending more

Before raising your ad budget, extract what's already in your hands. There's hidden revenue in your base and your network that doesn't cost a dollar more in ads.

Warm network

Your current network already trusts you. An organized approach to it generates very high-conversion meetings.

Cold prospecting on social

Outbound on Instagram and LinkedIn within the ICP. Predictable and controllable, it runs on the team's effort.

Expanding your current base

Repeat, upgrade and cross-sell to existing customers. The cheapest way to grow revenue.

Optimizing the close

Small gains in close rate and average deal size multiply revenue without a single new lead.

MOBILIZE THE INTERNAL TEAM

Put the whole company in active-prospecting mode for a period. Referrals asked for in a structured way (with a clear SOP) become a recurring channel, not a fluke.

Always track the performance metrics as you do this: the goal is to find which lever gives the most return per effort and double down on it.

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CHAPTER FIFTEEN

The plan: from guesswork to predictable

You don't have to do everything at once, you have to do it in the right order. This is the roadmap to get the operation off the paper without drowning.

Wk 1-2	Wk 3-4	Wk 5-8	Month 3+	Month 4+
Foundation	**Acquisition**	**Team**	**Management**	**Scale**
ICP, offer, product board, CRM live	VSL + social selling funnels, scripts and	hire 1 SDR + 1 Closer, train with	metrics, management routine, fix	AI, new channels, size the team

Weeks 1-2 · Foundation

Define your ICP, build the product ladder and the offer board, and get the CRM live with the 3 pipelines.

Weeks 3-4 · Acquisition

Publish the VSL and Social Selling funnels, write the SDR and closer scripts and set up the cadence.

Weeks 5-8 · Team

Hire 1 SDR and 1 closer through the hiring funnel. Train with pre-training, role play and recorded calls.

Month 3+ · Management & scale

Install the metrics routine, fix bottlenecks, roll out AI and size the team as traction grows.

THE SEQUENCE MATTERS

Don't hire before you have an offer and a funnel. Don't scale before you have metrics. Each phase prepares the next, skipping a step is the slowest shortcut there is.

CONCLUSION

Now you have the map. You just have to walk the path.

You've just seen, end to end, what a structured sales operation looks like: a designed offer, acquisition funnels, pre-sales with a cadence, sales with method, a post-sale that generates LTV, a sized team, a CRM and management by metrics.

None of this is unreachable theory. It's a system, and a system is built in stages. The company that leaves guesswork behind isn't the one with the best salesperson, it's the one that decided to treat sales as an asset and build, brick by brick, a machine that runs even without the owner out front.

> **The best time to structure your sales was last year. The second best is now.**

Your next 3 steps

1. Write your ICP and build the product board (Parts 1 and 2).
2. Get a marketing funnel and a sales funnel running, with a cadence (Part 3).
3. Structure your CRM and metrics before hiring and scaling (Parts 4 and 5).

NEXT STEP

Want help getting this off the paper faster?

Applying all of this on your own works, and it's a lot of work. If you want to shorten the path and avoid the costly mistakes, Usual Digital runs a **free sales diagnostic** of your operation: we look at your funnel, your metrics and your team, and show you where the biggest bottlenecks and the fastest revenue opportunities are.

Funnel diagnosis
Where you lose leads, meetings and sales today.

Metrics read
Your numbers compared with the ideal KPIs.

Action plan
The 3 highest-impact levers for the next 90 days.

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